

Neon Contraband

Game Design Document

Project Type: Mobile idle/management game

Engine: Unity

Target Platform: Android first, iOS later

Developer Scope: Solo developer

Monetization: Rewarded ads only for initial release

Genre: Idle tycoon / black-market management / risk-reward economy simulator

Tone: Futuristic, absurd, stylish, morally detached, satirical

Core Fantasy: Start with tiny street-level trades, grow into a fully automated underground distribution empire.

1. High-Level Concept

1.1 One-Sentence Pitch

A futuristic idle tycoon game where the player builds an underground candy-tech trading network, starting with one suspicious street deal and growing into a city-wide automated black-market empire.

1.2 Player Experience Goal

The player should feel like they are constantly discovering better opportunities, optimizing a shady but playful economic machine, and watching their tiny side hustle snowball into absurd scale.

The game should not feel like a realistic crime simulator. It should feel like a stylized forbidden capitalism toy box.

1.3 Design Pillars

Fast Micro-Rewards

The player should receive frequent positive feedback: money ticks, new orders, small upgrades, level-ups, unlocked products, rare events, glowing buttons, satisfying claim screens.

Simple Decisions, Meaningful Tradeoffs

The player should not need deep strategy. Choices should be readable:

- More profit but more heat.
- Safer supplier but lower margin.
- Faster delivery but higher risk.
- Bigger shipment but longer cooldown.

Stylish Secrecy Fantasy

The UI should feel like an encrypted underground marketplace: neon panels, glitch effects, fake aliases, mystery suppliers, anonymous clients.

Expandable Systems

The first version should be small but built with expandable templates for:

- New products
- New regions
- Seasonal event content
- Temporary suppliers
- Special missions
- Limited cosmetic themes
- New risk types

Solo-Developer Practicality

The game should avoid expensive systems:

- No real-time multiplayer
 - No 3D open world
 - No complex character animation
 - No advanced AI
 - No deep narrative branching
 - No live event dependency at launch
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2. Working Title and Alternatives

2.1 Main Working Title

Neon Contraband

2.2 Alternative Titles

- Shadow Sweets
- CandyNet
- Black Market Byte
- Side Hustle Syndicate
- Glitch Bazaar
- Sweet Supply
- UnderMarket
- HyperCandy Hustle
- Illegal Sugar
- NovaCandy Network

2.3 Recommended Direction

Use **Neon Contraband** during development. It is broad enough to support candies, gadgets, relics, fake luxury items, strange tech, and future expansions.

3. Fictional World and Lore

3.1 Setting

The game takes place in **Metro Delta**, a futuristic city where every product, snack, tool, toy, cosmetic, and comfort item is heavily regulated by corporate authorities.

The city is clean, sterile, expensive, and boring. Official stores sell approved products at absurd prices. Anything colorful, weird, nostalgic, experimental, or fun gets restricted, taxed, or banned.

This creates the underground economy.

The player enters the market by accident after meeting a suspicious street vendor selling a glowing candy-like object.

3.2 Core Fiction

The contraband in the game is not realistic drugs or weapons. It is exaggerated futuristic consumer nonsense:

- Glow candy
- Mood gum
- Anti-boredom soda
- Holographic stickers
- Illegal retro toys
- Imported flavor cubes
- Bootleg robot pets
- Emotion-filter sunglasses
- Unlicensed nostalgia snacks
- Forbidden luxury stationery
- Hyper-compressed ramen packs

The joke is that the city's laws are absurdly corporate, so even harmless fun products are treated like dangerous contraband.

3.3 Opening Scene

Intro Scene Summary

The screen is black. Neon rain ambience. A small distorted notification sound plays.

A mysterious vendor leans into frame. Only their coat, glowing visor, and hand are visible.

They hold a floating, glowing candy-shaped object: a wrapped hexagonal sweet with pulsing blue-pink light.

The vendor says:

“Psst, kid. Wanna buy some candy?”

The player taps the candy.

The vendor continues:

“Relax. It’s only illegal because it tastes better than the approved stuff.”

The player receives their first item:

1x NovaCandy Sample

The tutorial begins.

3.4 Why the Player Starts Trading

After receiving the sample, the player discovers that the candy has high resale demand. A nearby anonymous buyer offers double the price.

The player makes their first sale. The app-like underground market interface unlocks.

The vendor says:

“See? The city runs on rules. People run on cravings.”

The player is then introduced to the first supplier, first product, first buyer, first upgrade, and first risk meter.

3.5 Tone Rules

The game should be:

- Funny
- Stylish
- Slightly suspicious
- Futuristic
- Absurd
- Not realistic
- Not grim
- Not instructional

The game should avoid:

- Real drug names

- Real organized crime details
- Real-world trafficking references
- Human exploitation themes
- Realistic violence
- Serious criminal procedure

This is a cartoon economy about banned candy-tech and absurd corporate overregulation.

4. Target Audience

4.1 Primary Audience

Mobile players who enjoy:

- Idle games
- Tycoon games
- Upgrade games
- Number growth
- Collection systems
- Risk-reward mechanics
- Satisfying UI interaction
- Stylized dark/neon aesthetics

4.2 Secondary Audience

Players interested in:

- Satirical capitalism games
- Underground market fantasy
- Fake hacker/darknet UI themes
- Light management games
- Short-session mobile games

4.3 Session Length Target

Early Game

1–3 minutes per session.

Mid Game

3–7 minutes per session.

Late Game

5–10 minutes per session.

The game should remain playable in very short bursts.

5. Core Gameplay Loop

5.1 Main Loop

1. Buy products from suppliers.
2. Wait for shipment or instantly claim if ready.
3. Sell products to buyers or auto-sell through routes.
4. Earn credits.
5. Upgrade suppliers, storage, delivery, stealth, and automation.
6. Unlock new products and districts.
7. Manage heat risk.
8. Repeat with larger numbers and better systems.

5.2 Simplified Player Loop

Buy → Wait → Sell → Upgrade → Unlock → Optimize

5.3 Moment-to-Moment Actions

The player frequently:

- Taps to collect shipment
- Taps to sell batch
- Chooses supplier
- Buys upgrade
- Claims offline earnings
- Watches rewarded ad for bonus
- Reduces heat
- Unlocks district
- Completes small objective

5.4 Why This Loop Works

The loop combines:

- Anticipation from waiting
 - Reward from claiming
 - Strategy from choosing risk/profit
 - Progression from upgrades
 - Completion from objectives
 - Status from empire growth
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6. Game Structure

6.1 Main Screens

1. Dashboard

The main hub. Shows current money, income rate, heat, active shipments, and recommended action.

2. Market

Where players buy products from suppliers.

3. Inventory

Shows stored products and their sell values.

4. Routes

Where players assign products to delivery channels for automatic income.

5. Upgrades

Permanent improvements to profit, speed, storage, safety, automation, and offline earnings.

6. District Map

Unlockable city regions with different demands, risk levels, and supplier types.

7. Contacts

Supplier, buyer, courier, fixer, and informant characters.

8. Objectives

Short-term tasks and milestone rewards.

9. Settings

Audio, language, privacy, restore purchases if future IAP is added, credits.

6.2 Minimum Viable Screen Set

For the first playable version:

- Dashboard
- Market
- Inventory
- Upgrades
- District Map

- Settings

Routes and Contacts can be added after the core economy works.

7. Core Resources

7.1 Credits

Primary currency.

Used for:

- Buying products
- Buying upgrades
- Unlocking districts
- Expanding storage
- Hiring automation agents

Displayed as:

¢ 1,250

7.2 Heat

Risk meter representing corporate enforcement attention.

Heat increases when the player:

- Buys risky products
- Uses cheap suppliers
- Runs high-volume shipments
- Ignores inspection warnings
- Expands into strict districts

Heat decreases through:

- Waiting
- Buying stealth upgrades
- Paying fixers
- Watching rewarded ads for emergency cooldown
- Completing low-profile objectives

Heat should be simple. It is not a realistic law enforcement system.

7.3 Reputation

Progression score used to unlock better suppliers and districts.

Reputation increases when the player:

- Completes sales
- Finishes objectives
- Unlocks new products
- Reaches income milestones

7.4 Storage

Limits how many product units the player can hold.

Storage creates pressure to:

- Sell regularly
- Upgrade warehouse capacity
- Automate routes

7.5 Influence

Late-game resource unlocked after District 3.

Used for:

- Passive bonuses
- District control
- Advanced upgrades
- Prestige system

This can be excluded from MVP if needed.

8. Products

8.1 Product Design Rules

Each product should have:

- Name
- Icon
- Rarity
- Buy price
- Sell price
- Demand modifier
- Heat value
- Supplier availability
- Unlock requirement
- Short flavor description

Products should feel collectible and funny.

8.2 Product Categories

Candy-Tech

Bright, weird snacks and flavor objects.

Examples:

- NovaCandy
- GlowGum
- Static Taffy
- Quantum Pop Rocks
- Dream Licorice
- Mood Mints

Retro Relics

Banned nostalgic entertainment products.

Examples:

- Pixel Pet Cartridge
- Analog Sticker Pack
- Illegal Yo-Yo
- Bootleg Arcade Token
- Forbidden Cassette

Comfort Goods

Small happiness-related products restricted by corporate policy.

Examples:

- Unlicensed Plush Cube
- Memory Tea Sachet
- WarmLight Bulb
- Anti-Monday Socks

Vanity Mods

Status and identity items.

Examples:

- Holo Nail Polish
- Emotion Lens
- Fake VIP Badge
- Mood Ring 2.0

Black-Box Tech

Late-game mysterious devices.

Examples:

- Pocket Cloud Core
- Whisper Battery
- Ghost SIM
- Forbidden Firmware Chip

8.3 Rarity Tiers

Rarity	Color Direction	Purpose
Common	White/gray	Basic goods, low profit, low heat
Uncommon	Green/cyan	Better margins, mild heat
Rare	Blue/purple	Strong profit, notable risk
Epic	Pink/orange	High profit, special events
Legendary	Gold/glitch rainbow	Very rare, huge payout, high heat

8.4 Example Product Data

Product	Category	Rarity	Base Buy	Base Sell	Heat	Unlock
NovaCandy	Candy-Tech	Common	10	16	1	Tutorial
GlowGum	Candy-Tech	Common	25	41	2	Reputation 2
Static Taffy	Candy-Tech	Uncommon	80	140	4	District 1
Pixel Pet Cartridge	Retro Relic	Uncommon	120	210	5	District 2
Mood Mints	Candy-Tech	Rare	350	690	8	Supplier Level 4
Ghost SIM	Black-Box Tech	Epic	2,500	6,000	18	District 4

9. Suppliers

9.1 Supplier Role

Suppliers sell products to the player. Each supplier has a personality, product pool, risk profile, prices, cooldowns, and upgrade levels.

9.2 Supplier Stats

Each supplier has:

- Supplier ID
- Display name
- Alias
- Portrait icon
- Product pool
- Price multiplier
- Heat multiplier
- Shipment speed
- Reliability
- Unlock requirement
- Level

9.3 Supplier Types

Street Vendor

Low-level, cheap, mildly risky.

Backroom Importer

Better variety, medium cost, medium heat.

Corporate Leaker

Expensive, rare goods, low heat.

Glitch Broker

Randomized inventory, extreme deals, unpredictable risk.

Luxury Smuggler

High price, high-margin vanity products.

9.4 Example Suppliers

Moth

Alias: Moth

Type: Street Vendor

Unlock: Tutorial

Personality: Speaks in half-jokes and bad advice.

Products: NovaCandy, GlowGum, Static Taffy

Special Bonus: 5% cheaper Candy-Tech products.

Auntie Circuit

Type: Backroom Importer

Unlock: Reputation 5

Personality: Warm, terrifying, calls everyone "dear."

Products: Retro Relics and Comfort Goods

Special Bonus: Shipment cooldown reduced by 10%.

Bluejay

Type: Corporate Leaker

Unlock: District 3

Personality: Cold, precise, sends one-word messages.

Products: Black-Box Tech

Special Bonus: Heat gain reduced by 15%.

NullKid

Type: Glitch Broker

Unlock: Reputation 15

Personality: Chaotic, glitchy, probably thirteen fake accounts in a coat.

Products: Random rotating inventory

Special Bonus: Chance for massive discount or surprise heat spike.

10. Buyers and Demand

10.1 Buyer Role

Buyers convert inventory into credits. Early game selling is manual. Later, routes automate selling.

10.2 Buyer Types

Walk-Up Buyer

Simple instant sale.

Collector

Pays extra for rare goods.

Influencer

Creates temporary demand spike.

Corporate Intern

Buys products secretly, low heat.

Bulk Buyer

Large volume, lower margin, fast inventory clearing.

10.3 Demand System

Each district has demand modifiers for product categories.

Example:

District	Candy-Tech	Retro Relics	Comfort Goods	Vanity Mods	Black-Box Tech
Back Alley	1.0x	0.8x	1.0x	0.7x	0.5x
Dorm Stack	1.4x	1.2x	1.1x	1.0x	0.6x
Neon Mall	1.1x	1.0x	0.8x	1.6x	0.9x
Corporate Row	0.8x	0.7x	1.2x	1.1x	1.8x

Demand should be simple enough to understand visually.

10.4 Demand Events

Temporary modifiers lasting a few minutes or sessions.

Examples:

- "Exam Week: Mood Mints demand +50%"
- "Retro Trend: Retro Relics +40%"
- "Corporate Audit: Heat gain +25%"
- "Rainy Night: Comfort Goods +30%"

These can run offline as random events, not live server events.

11. Districts

11.1 District Role

Districts are progression zones. Each district unlocks new products, buyers, suppliers, demand profiles, upgrades, and risk levels.

11.2 District Unlock Flow

1. Back Alley
2. Dorm Stack
3. Neon Mall
4. Corporate Row
5. Skyrail Terminal

6. Old Arcade Quarter
7. Glass Tower Basement
8. The Null Market

11.3 District Data

Each district has:

- ID
- Display name
- Art background
- Unlock cost
- Reputation requirement
- Heat baseline
- Demand modifiers
- Supplier unlocks
- Product unlocks
- Objective set

11.4 Example Districts

Back Alley

Starting district. Dirty neon walls, vending machines, rain puddles.

Gameplay purpose:

- Tutorial
- Basic sales
- Low-risk products

Dorm Stack

Student housing megablock. High demand for cheap joy and stress relief.

Gameplay purpose:

- Introduces demand bonuses
- Introduces inventory pressure

Neon Mall

Corporate-approved shopping center after dark. High vanity demand.

Gameplay purpose:

- Introduces high-margin goods
- Introduces stricter heat

Corporate Row

Office towers, exhausted workers, secret buyers.

Gameplay purpose:

- Introduces Black-Box Tech
- Introduces low-volume high-profit sales

The Null Market

A hidden digital marketplace inside broken city infrastructure.

Gameplay purpose:

- Late-game advanced mechanics
 - Prestige gateway
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12. Heat and Risk System

12.1 Purpose

Heat prevents the game from becoming pure automatic profit. It adds tension without becoming punishing.

12.2 Heat Scale

Heat ranges from 0 to 100.

Heat Range	Status	Effect
0–24	Cold	No penalty
25–49	Watched	Slight chance of inspection
50–74	Hot	Higher fees, slower shipments
75–99	Critical	Inspection events likely
100	Lockdown	Temporary forced cooldown

12.3 Heat Events

Inspection Ping

Player gets a warning and can choose:

- Wait it out
- Pay credits

- Use fixer token
- Watch rewarded ad to reduce heat

Shipment Flagged

A shipment is delayed. Player can:

- Accept delay
- Pay extra
- Cancel shipment
- Watch rewarded ad to clear issue

District Sweep

One district becomes temporarily less profitable or higher heat.

12.4 Lockdown

When heat reaches 100:

- Active shipments pause briefly
- Player pays small penalty or waits
- Heat resets to 60
- Player receives a clear lesson: reckless scaling needs safety upgrades

Lockdown should sting but not destroy progress.

12.5 Heat Reduction Methods

- Passive decay over time
 - Stealth upgrades
 - Fixer contacts
 - Low-risk sales
 - Objective rewards
 - Rewarded ad emergency action
-

13. Upgrades

13.1 Upgrade Categories

Profit Upgrades

Increase sale price or margin.

Examples:

- Better Packaging
- Fake Premium Labels

- Demand Forecasting
- Buyer Profiling

Supply Upgrades

Improve buying, shipment speed, or supplier inventory.

Examples:

- Larger Orders
- Supplier Trust
- Quiet Couriers
- Backroom Access

Storage Upgrades

Increase inventory capacity.

Examples:

- Hidden Locker
- Basement Shelf
- Van Compartment
- Pocket Warehouse

Heat Upgrades

Reduce risk and penalties.

Examples:

- Signal Scrambler
- Decoy Receipts
- Boring-Looking Boxes
- Corporate Compliance Stickers

Automation Upgrades

Reduce manual input.

Examples:

- Auto-Seller Bot
- Route Scheduler
- Buyer Alerts
- Shipment Collector Drone

Offline Upgrades

Improve earnings while away.

Examples:

- Night Crew
- Sleep Mode Sales
- Offline Courier Chain

13.2 Upgrade Scaling

Use exponential cost scaling.

Example formula:

```
UpgradeCost = BaseCost * pow(CostMultiplier, CurrentLevel)
```

Typical cost multiplier:

- Cheap upgrades: 1.15
- Medium upgrades: 1.25
- Powerful upgrades: 1.4

13.3 Upgrade UX Rules

Each upgrade button should clearly show:

- Current level
- Cost
- Effect
- Next level effect
- Whether affordable

Example:

Better Packaging Lv. 4

Sale value +20% → +25%

Cost: ₺ 1,250

14. Automation

14.1 Purpose

Automation is a major retention driver. The player should start manually, then gradually feel like they built a machine.

14.2 Automation Unlocks

Stage 1: Manual

Player buys and sells manually.

Stage 2: Auto-Sell

Specific products can auto-sell when inventory exceeds threshold.

Stage 3: Routes

Player assigns product categories to districts for passive income.

Stage 4: Auto-Buy

Trusted suppliers can automatically refill inventory.

Stage 5: Network Mode

Player manages high-level modifiers instead of individual trades.

14.3 MVP Automation

For first release, include:

- Auto-sell upgrade
- Offline earnings
- Optional shipment auto-claim upgrade

Routes can be added later if scope gets too large.

15. Objectives and Missions

15.1 Objective Role

Objectives guide players through progression and provide short-term goals.

15.2 Objective Types

- Sell X units of product
- Earn X credits
- Reach supplier level X
- Unlock district
- Reduce heat from X to Y
- Buy X upgrades
- Hold X inventory
- Complete X shipments

15.3 Example Early Objectives

1. Buy 5 NovaCandy.
2. Sell 5 NovaCandy.
3. Upgrade Better Packaging once.
4. Reach \$ 100 total earnings.
5. Unlock GlowGum.
6. Keep heat below 25 for 3 shipments.
7. Unlock Dorm Stack.

15.4 Mission Rewards

Rewards can include:

- Credits
 - Reputation
 - Temporary demand boost
 - Free product sample
 - Heat reduction
 - Supplier XP
-

16. Prestige System

16.1 Purpose

Prestige gives long-term replayability once the player reaches late-game.

16.2 Fiction

The player wipes their public network and relaunches under a new encrypted identity.

Prestige is called:

Rebrand

16.3 Rebrand Mechanics

When the player Rebrands:

- Credits reset
- Products reset
- Districts reset
- Most upgrades reset
- Player gains Influence
- Influence buys permanent boosts

16.4 Prestige Unlock

Unlock after:

- District 5 unlocked
- Total lifetime earnings threshold reached
- Reputation level 25

This can be delayed until after initial launch.

17. Monetization

17.1 Launch Monetization

Only rewarded ads.

No forced ads for initial version.

17.2 Rewarded Ad Placements

Double Offline Earnings

When player returns after being away.

Rush Shipment

Finish shipment instantly.

Reduce Heat

Emergency heat reduction.

Bonus Buyer

Special buyer appears and offers higher sale price.

Free Supplier Refresh

Refresh supplier inventory.

Lucky Crate

Receive small random product bundle.

17.3 Rewarded Ad Rules

Rewarded ads should feel optional and useful, not required.

Do not block core progression behind ads.

Good rewarded ad design:

- Clear reward
- No trick wording
- Limited frequency
- Never forced after button press unless player chose ad

17.4 Ad Cooldowns

Suggested cooldowns:

Placement	Cooldown
Double offline earnings	Once per return session
Rush shipment	5 minutes
Reduce heat	10 minutes
Bonus buyer	7 minutes
Supplier refresh	10 minutes
Lucky crate	15 minutes

18. Economy Design

18.1 Economy Goals

The economy should create:

- Fast early progress
- Medium-term upgrade planning
- Occasional bottlenecks
- Strong satisfaction from unlocking new districts
- Increasing income scale

18.2 Early Game Target

Within first 5 minutes, player should:

- Complete tutorial
- Buy and sell NovaCandy
- Buy first upgrade
- Unlock GlowGum
- Experience first minor heat warning
- Understand the core loop

18.3 First Session Target

Within 10–15 minutes, player should:

- Unlock second product
- Reach first supplier level-up
- Buy storage upgrade
- See offline earning explanation
- Have at least one rewarded ad opportunity
- Be close to unlocking District 2

18.4 Example Economy Curve

Stage	Player Income	Main Goal
Tutorial	₺ 10–100	Learn buy/sell
Early	₺ 100–1,000	Unlock products/upgrades
Early-Mid	₺ 1,000–10,000	Unlock districts
Mid	₺ 10,000–100,000	Automation
Late	₺ 100,000+	Prestige preparation

18.5 Balancing Rule

The player should almost always be 1–3 sessions away from something meaningful.

Meaningful goals include:

- New product
- New supplier
- New district
- Automation upgrade
- Storage expansion
- Heat reduction upgrade
- Reputation level

19. User Interface Design

19.1 Visual Theme

The UI should resemble a secret encrypted market app.

Visual ingredients:

- Dark background
- Neon cyan, magenta, purple accents

- Soft glow borders
- Glitch transitions
- Rounded rectangular panels
- Fake terminal labels
- Anonymous profile icons
- Product cards
- Progress bars
- Notification pings

19.2 UI Style Rules

- Large buttons for mobile fingers
- Clear hierarchy
- Minimal text per screen
- Reward numbers should animate upward
- Heat should always be visible
- Affordable upgrades should glow subtly
- Important claims should pulse
- Never hide the next goal

19.3 Main HUD

Persistent top bar:

- Credits
- Heat meter
- Reputation level
- Storage count

Example:

\$ 2,450	HEAT 18%	REP 4	32/50
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19.4 Dashboard Layout

Top:

- Credits
- Heat
- Reputation

Center:

- Active shipment card
- Sell inventory card
- Current objective card

Bottom navigation:

- Market
- Inventory

- Upgrades
- Districts
- More

19.5 Product Card Layout

Each product card shows:

- Icon
- Product name
- Rarity frame
- Buy price
- Sell value estimate
- Heat value
- Quantity owned
- Buy button

19.6 Upgrade Card Layout

Each upgrade card shows:

- Icon
 - Upgrade name
 - Current level
 - Current effect
 - Next effect
 - Cost
 - Buy button
-

20. Art Direction

20.1 Overall Art Style

2D stylized neon UI with simple icons and limited character art.

Recommended style:

- Flat vector-like shapes
- Glowing outlines
- Slight pixel/glitch effects
- Dark sci-fi backgrounds
- Minimal animation
- Strong silhouettes

20.2 Why 2D UI-Heavy Is Recommended

It is much more realistic for a solo developer because it avoids:

- 3D character modeling
- Rigging
- Large environment production
- Camera control issues
- Complex animation blending

20.3 Character Art

Characters can be:

- Bust portraits
- Silhouettes
- Masked faces
- Static images with blinking/glitch animation
- Limited expression variants

Each major contact needs only:

- Neutral portrait
- Happy/success portrait
- Warning portrait

20.4 Product Icons

Product icons are crucial. They are the collectible visual reward.

Each product icon should be:

- Readable at small size
- Distinct silhouette
- Strong rarity color frame
- Slight glow effect

20.5 Backgrounds

District backgrounds can be static layered images with small animated details.

Examples:

- Rain streak overlay
 - Blinking sign
 - Moving scanline
 - Steam puff
 - Passing light streak
-

21. Animation Design

21.1 Animation Priorities

Most animation should be UI polish, not complex character movement.

Highest-value animations:

- Money count-up
- Button press bounce
- Product card reveal
- Shipment arrival pulse
- Heat meter warning shake
- Unlock screen glow
- Reward chest opening
- District unlock transition
- Supplier portrait glitch-in

21.2 Animation List

UI Animations

Animation	Use	Length
Button_Press_Bounce	All buttons	0.12s
Panel_Slide_In	Opening panels	0.25s
Panel_Slide_Out	Closing panels	0.2s
Currency_Count_Up	Earning credits	0.5s
Reward_Pulse	Claimable rewards	Loop 1.2s
Heat_Warning_Shake	Heat warning	0.35s
Unlock_Glow_Burst	Unlocks	0.8s
Card_Reveal_Flip	Product reveal	0.45s
Glitch_Transition	Screen change	0.3s

Product Animations

Animation	Use	Length
Product_Idle_Glow	Rare item icon idle	Loop 1.5s
Product_Pop_In	Acquired item	0.25s
Product_Sell_Fly	Item flies to credits	0.5s
Product_Rarity_Sparkle	Rare reveal	1.0s

Character Animations

Animation	Use	Length
Contact_Glitch_In	Contact appears	0.35s
Contact_Blink	Idle portrait	Loop random
Contact_Warning_Flicker	Warning state	Loop 0.8s
Contact_Success_Nod	Sale success	0.5s

District Animations

Animation	Use	Length
District_Rain_Loop	Back Alley	Loop
District_Neon_Blink	Neon Mall signs	Loop
District_Scanline	Corporate Row	Loop
District_Unlock_Zoom	New district unlock	0.8s

22. Sprite Sheets and Asset Sheets

22.1 Sprite Sheet Strategy

Use sprite atlases grouped by purpose:

- UI atlas
- Product icons atlas
- Character portraits atlas
- District backgrounds atlas
- VFX atlas

This reduces draw calls and keeps assets organized.

22.2 Recommended Sprite Sheet Sizes

Sheet	Size	Notes
UI_Common	2048x2048	Buttons, panels, bars, icons
Products_Tier01	2048x2048	Common/uncommon product icons
Products_Tier02	2048x2048	Rare/epic/legendary icons
Contacts_Main	2048x2048	Supplier portraits
Districts_BG	Individual 1920x1080	Use separate compressed backgrounds

Sheet	Size	Notes
VFX_Common	1024x1024	Sparkles, glows, particles

22.3 Product Icon Sheet

Each product icon should be designed at:

- Source size: 512x512
- In-game display: 64x64, 96x96, or 128x128

Product Icon Naming

```
spr_product_[category]_[productname]_[rarity]
```

Examples:

- spr_product_candy_novacandy_common
- spr_product_candy_glowgum_common
- spr_product_candy_statictaffy_uncommon
- spr_product_retro_pixelpet_uncommon
- spr_product_tech_ghostsim_epic

22.4 UI Asset Sheet

Required UI Sprites

- Button normal
- Button pressed
- Button disabled
- Panel background
- Product card background
- Upgrade card background
- Rarity frames
- Heat bar fill
- Heat bar warning fill
- Currency icon
- Reputation icon
- Storage icon
- Lock icon
- Claim icon
- Warning icon
- Ad reward icon

UI Naming

```
spr_ui_[element]_[state]
```

Examples:

- `spr_ui_button_primary_normal`
- `spr_ui_button_primary_pressed`
- `spr_ui_button_primary_disabled`
- `spr_ui_panel_dark_default`
- `spr_ui_card_product_common`
- `spr_ui_card_product_rare`
- `spr_ui_icon_currency_credit`
- `spr_ui_icon_heat_warning`

22.5 Character Portrait Sheet

Character Source Size

- Portrait source: 1024x1024
- In-game portrait: 256x256 or 512x512

Character Naming

`spr_contact_[contactid]_[emotion]`

Examples:

- `spr_contact_moth_neutral`
- `spr_contact_moth_success`
- `spr_contact_moth_warning`
- `spr_contact_auntiecircuit_neutral`
- `spr_contact_bluejay_warning`

22.6 VFX Sheet

VFX Naming

`spr_vfx_[effect]_[frame]`

Examples:

- `spr_vfx_glowburst_00`
- `spr_vfx_glowburst_01`
- `spr_vfx_sparkle_00`
- `spr_vfx_glitchline_00`
- `spr_vfx_currencyfly_00`

22.7 Animation Clip Naming

`anim_[object]_[action]`

Examples:

- anim_ui_button_press
 - anim_ui_panel_slidein
 - anim_ui_heat_warning_shake
 - anim_product_card_reveal
 - anim_contact_moth_glitchin
 - anim_district_backalley_rainloop
-

23. Audio Design

23.1 Audio Style

Audio should be minimal, electronic, tactile, and satisfying.

Style references:

- Soft synth clicks
- Glitch pings
- Low bass pulses
- Digital notification sounds
- Futuristic vending machine noises

23.2 Music

Looping background music by district.

Early game music should be chill and sneaky.

Late game music can become more energetic.

23.3 Sound Effects

Required SFX

Sound	Use
sfx_button_tap	Button press
sfx_buy_product	Buying product
sfx_sell_product	Selling product
sfx_currency_gain	Credits gained
sfx_upgrade_purchase	Upgrade bought
sfx_unlock	New unlock

Sound	Use
sfx_warning_heat	Heat warning
sfx_shipment_arrive	Shipment ready
sfx_ad_reward_claim	Rewarded ad reward granted
sfx_glitch_transition	Screen transition

23.4 Audio Naming

`sfx_[category]_[action]`

Examples:

- `sfx_ui_button_tap`
- `sfx_market_buy_product`
- `sfx_market_sell_product`
- `sfx_system_unlock`
- `sfx_system_heat_warning`

Music naming:

`mus_[district]_[mood]_loop`

Examples:

- `mus_backalley_sneaky_loop`
- `mus_neonmall_slick_loop`
- `mus_corporaterow_cold_loop`

24. Unity Project Structure

24.1 Folder Structure

```
Assets/
  _Project/
    Art/
      Sprites/
        UI/
        Products/
        Contacts/
        Districts/
        VFX/
      Materials/
      Fonts/
    Audio/
```

```
SFX/  
Music/  
Data/  
  ScriptableObjects/  
    Products/  
    Suppliers/  
    Districts/  
    Upgrades/  
    Objectives/  
    Events/  
Prefabs/  
  UI/  
  Systems/  
  Cards/  
  Popups/  
  Effects/  
Scenes/  
  Boot.unity  
  Main.unity  
Scripts/  
  Core/  
  Data/  
  Economy/  
  Gameplay/  
  UI/  
  Ads/  
  Save/  
  Utilities/  
Animations/  
  UI/  
  Products/  
  Contacts/  
  Districts/  
Addressables/  
Localization/  
Tests/
```

24.2 Scene Structure

Boot Scene

Responsible for:

- App initialization
- Save loading
- Data loading
- Service setup
- Transition to Main scene

Main Scene

Contains:

- Main UI canvas
- Game systems
- Audio manager
- Ad manager
- Popup manager
- Navigation controller

Keep the project simple. Avoid many scenes unless needed.

25. Unity Naming Conventions

25.1 General Rule

Names should be searchable, consistent, and boring. Cute names belong in game content, not in files/classes.

25.2 Prefixes

Type	Prefix	Example
Scene	scn_	scn_boot
Prefab	pf_	pf_product_card
Sprite	spr_	spr_product_candy_novacandy_common
Animation Clip	anim_	anim_ui_button_press
Animator Controller	ac_	ac_contact_portrait
ScriptableObject Asset	so_	so_product_novacandy
Material	mat_	mat_ui_neon_glow
Audio SFX	sfx_	sfx_ui_button_tap
Music	mus_	mus_backalley_sneaky_loop
Font	font_	font_neon_primary
VFX Prefab	vfx_	vfx_unlock_burst

25.3 Script Naming

C# scripts use PascalCase.

Examples:

- GameManager.cs
- EconomyManager.cs
- HeatManager.cs
- ProductData.cs
- ProductInventory.cs
- MarketController.cs
- UpgradeService.cs
- SaveManager.cs

25.4 Variable Naming

Use camelCase for private fields and PascalCase for public properties.

Recommended style:

```
private int currentCredits;  
public int CurrentCredits => currentCredits;
```

For serialized private fields:

```
[SerializeField] private ProductData productData;  
[SerializeField] private TMP_Text priceText;
```

26. Core Code Architecture

26.1 Architecture Goal

Use a simple, functional architecture that is good enough for a solo Unity project.

Do not over-engineer.

Recommended pattern:

- ScriptableObjects for static data
- Manager/services for game systems
- UI controllers for screens
- Save data as plain serializable classes
- Events for UI updates

26.2 Main Systems

GameManager

Coordinates app state.

Responsibilities:

- Initialize systems
- Track game readiness
- Handle pause/resume
- Trigger save

EconomyManager

Handles money and transactions.

Responsibilities:

- Add credits
- Spend credits
- Validate purchases
- Broadcast credit changes

InventoryManager

Tracks product quantities.

Responsibilities:

- Add product
- Remove product
- Check storage capacity
- Get inventory counts

MarketManager

Handles buying and selling.

Responsibilities:

- Buy product
- Sell product
- Calculate buy/sell prices
- Apply demand modifiers
- Apply supplier modifiers

HeatManager

Tracks heat.

Responsibilities:

- Add heat
- Reduce heat
- Trigger heat warnings
- Handle lockdown

UpgradeManager

Tracks upgrade levels and effects.

Responsibilities:

- Buy upgrades
- Apply upgrade effects
- Calculate upgrade costs

DistrictManager

Tracks unlocked and active districts.

Responsibilities:

- Unlock district
- Get demand modifiers
- Get available suppliers/products

ObjectiveManager

Tracks active objectives.

Responsibilities:

- Evaluate progress
- Claim objective rewards
- Generate next objectives

OfflineProgressManager

Calculates earnings while app is closed.

Responsibilities:

- Save exit timestamp
- Calculate offline duration
- Apply offline earnings cap
- Offer ad doubling

AdsManager

Handles rewarded ads.

Responsibilities:

- Check ad availability
- Show rewarded ad
- Grant reward after completion
- Track cooldowns

SaveManager

Handles save/load.

Responsibilities:

- Serialize save data
- Deserialize save data
- Auto-save
- Backup save validation

AudioManager

Handles sound and music.

Responsibilities:

- Play SFX
- Play music
- Volume settings

27. Suggested C# Classes

27.1 Data Classes / ScriptableObjects

ProductData

Static data for each product.

Fields:

- string ProductId
- string DisplayName
- ProductCategory Category
- Rarity Rarity
- Sprite Icon
- double BaseBuyPrice
- double BaseSellPrice
- int HeatValue
- string UnlockRequirementId
- string Description

SupplierData

Static data for suppliers.

Fields:

- string SupplierId
- string DisplayName
- SupplierType Type
- Sprite PortraitNeutral
- Sprite PortraitSuccess
- Sprite PortraitWarning
- List<ProductData> ProductPool
- float PriceMultiplier
- float HeatMultiplier
- float ShipmentSpeedMultiplier
- string UnlockRequirementId

DistrictData

Static data for districts.

Fields:

- string DistrictId
- string DisplayName
- Sprite Background
- double UnlockCost
- int RequiredReputation
- int BaseHeat
- List<DemandModifier> DemandModifiers
- List<SupplierData> SuppliersUnlocked
- List<ProductData> ProductsUnlocked

UpgradeData

Static data for upgrades.

Fields:

- string UpgradeId
- string DisplayName
- UpgradeCategory Category
- Sprite Icon
- double BaseCost
- float CostMultiplier
- float EffectPerLevel
- int MaxLevel
- string Description

ObjectiveData

Static data for objectives.

Fields:

- string ObjectiveId
- string DisplayName
- ObjectiveType Type
- string TargetId
- double TargetAmount
- RewardData Reward

RewardData

Serializable reward container.

Fields:

- double Credits
- int Reputation
- int HeatReduction
- List<ProductReward> ProductRewards

27.2 Runtime Classes

PlayerState

Main save state container.

Fields:

- double Credits
- int Reputation
- int Heat
- Dictionary<string, int> Inventory
- Dictionary<string, int> UpgradeLevels
- List<string> UnlockedDistrictIds
- List<string> UnlockedProductIds
- List<string> UnlockedSupplierIds
- DateTime LastSaveTime

InventoryItemState

Runtime inventory entry.

Fields:

- string ProductId
- int Quantity

ShipmentState

Tracks active shipment.

Fields:

- string ShipmentId
- string SupplierId
- string ProductId
- int Quantity
- DateTime StartTime
- DateTime CompleteTime
- bool IsClaimed

ObjectiveProgressState

Tracks objective progress.

Fields:

- string ObjectiveId
- double CurrentAmount
- bool IsCompleted
- bool IsClaimed

28. Enumerations

Suggested enums:

```
public enum ProductCategory
{
    CandyTech,
    RetroRelic,
    ComfortGood,
    VanityMod,
    BlackBoxTech
}

public enum Rarity
{
    Common,
    Uncommon,
    Rare,
    Epic,
    Legendary
}

public enum SupplierType
```

```
{
    StreetVendor,
    BackroomImporter,
    CorporateLeaker,
    GlitchBroker,
    LuxurySmuggler
}

public enum UpgradeCategory
{
    Profit,
    Supply,
    Storage,
    Heat,
    Automation,
    Offline
}

public enum ObjectiveType
{
    SellProduct,
    EarnCredits,
    BuyUpgrade,
    UnlockDistrict,
    ReduceHeat,
    CompleteShipment,
    ReachReputation
}

public enum RewardedAdPlacement
{
    DoubleOfflineEarnings,
    RushShipment,
    ReduceHeat,
    BonusBuyer,
    SupplierRefresh,
    LuckyCrate
}
```

29. Save System

29.1 Save Format

Use JSON for early development.

Later, add lightweight obfuscation if needed.

29.2 Save Triggers

Save when:

- App pauses
- App quits
- Player buys/sells
- Player unlocks something
- Player claims objective
- Every 30 seconds during active play

29.3 Offline Progress

On save:

- Store UTC timestamp

On load:

- Calculate seconds elapsed
- Clamp offline time to max allowed duration
- Calculate offline earnings from automation systems
- Show offline earnings popup

29.4 Offline Earnings Cap

Suggested initial cap:

- Base cap: 2 hours
- Upgrade cap: up to 12 hours

29.5 Anti-Abuse

For initial launch, do not obsess over cheating.

Basic checks:

- Ignore negative time differences
 - Clamp huge offline duration
 - Detect impossible future timestamps and reset gracefully
-

30. Data-Driven Design

30.1 Why Data-Driven

The game will contain many products, suppliers, districts, upgrades, and objectives. Hardcoding them will become painful fast.

Use ScriptableObjects so content can be edited in Unity Inspector.

30.2 Data IDs

Every major content item needs a stable string ID.

Examples:

- product_novacandy
- product_glowgum
- supplier_moth
- district_backalley
- upgrade_better_packaging
- objective_sell_novacandy_01

Never use display names as IDs.

31. Tutorial Design

31.1 Tutorial Goals

Teach:

- Buy product
- Sell product
- Earn credits
- Buy upgrade
- Understand heat
- Claim objective

Do not teach everything at once.

31.2 Tutorial Flow

Step 1: Intro

Moth appears.

Text:

“Psst, kid. Wanna buy some candy?”

Player taps NovaCandy.

Step 2: First Buy

Highlight Buy button.

Text:

"First one's cheap. That's how they get you. I mean suppliers. Totally suppliers."

Player buys 5 NovaCandy.

Step 3: First Sale

Highlight Sell button.

Text:

"Someone nearby wants those. Sell fast before they remember budgeting exists."

Player sells NovaCandy.

Step 4: First Upgrade

Highlight Better Packaging.

Text:

"Same candy. Shinier wrapper. Higher price. Civilization!"

Player buys upgrade.

Step 5: Heat Introduction

Heat meter pulses.

Text:

"See that little meter? That's attention. Attention is expensive."

Player completes one more shipment and gains heat.

Step 6: First Objective Claim

Objective panel highlights.

Text:

"Do tiny crimes, get tiny prizes. That's called business."

Player claims reward.

Step 7: Freedom

Text:

“You’re in the market now. Stay cold. Sell weird.”

Tutorial ends.

32. Content Plan for MVP

32.1 MVP Features

Required:

- Credits
- Heat
- Reputation
- Inventory
- Buy products
- Sell products
- Suppliers
- Product unlocks
- District unlocks
- Upgrades
- Objectives
- Offline earnings
- Rewarded ads
- Save/load
- Basic tutorial

Optional for MVP:

- Routes
- Prestige
- Daily missions
- Random demand events
- Supplier refresh

32.2 MVP Content Counts

Recommended minimum:

Content Type	MVP Count
Products	20
Suppliers	4
Districts	4
Upgrades	18
Objectives	40

Content Type	MVP Count
Random events	10
Contact portraits	4 characters × 3 moods
District backgrounds	4

32.3 Product MVP List

Candy-Tech

1. NovaCandy
2. GlowGum
3. Static Taffy
4. Quantum Pop Rocks
5. Mood Mints
6. Dream Licorice

Retro Relics

1. Pixel Pet Cartridge
2. Analog Sticker Pack
3. Bootleg Arcade Token
4. Forbidden Cassette

Comfort Goods

1. WarmLight Bulb
2. Memory Tea Sachet
3. Anti-Monday Socks
4. Unlicensed Plush Cube

Vanity Mods

1. Holo Nail Polish
2. Emotion Lens
3. Fake VIP Badge

Black-Box Tech

1. Ghost SIM
2. Whisper Battery
3. Forbidden Firmware Chip

32.4 MVP Supplier List

1. Moth
2. Auntie Circuit
3. Bluejay
4. NullKid

32.5 MVP District List

1. Back Alley
2. Dorm Stack
3. Neon Mall
4. Corporate Row

32.6 MVP Upgrade List

Profit

1. Better Packaging
2. Fake Premium Labels
3. Buyer Psychology

Supply

1. Supplier Trust
2. Bulk Ordering
3. Quiet Couriers

Storage

1. Hidden Locker
2. Basement Shelf
3. Pocket Warehouse

Heat

1. Signal Scrambler
2. Decoy Receipts
3. Boring Boxes

Automation

1. Auto-Seller Bot
2. Shipment Alerts
3. Auto-Claim Drone

Offline

1. Night Crew
 2. Sleep Mode Sales
 3. Offline Courier Chain
-

33. Progression Plan

33.1 Early Game

Goal:

- Teach loop
- Make player feel fast progress
- Unlock new products quickly

Player should unlock:

- NovaCandy
- GlowGum
- Better Packaging
- Hidden Locker
- First heat warning

33.2 Mid Game

Goal:

- Introduce optimization
- Push storage and heat upgrades
- Unlock new districts

Player should unlock:

- Dorm Stack
- Neon Mall
- Auntie Circuit
- More product categories
- Auto-sell

33.3 Late Game

Goal:

- Larger numbers
- Automation
- Rare goods
- Prestige preparation

Player should unlock:

- Corporate Row
- Bluejay
- Black-Box Tech
- Offline upgrades
- Rebrand system later

34. Reward Psychology

34.1 Reward Types

Predictable Rewards

Player knows exactly what they get.

Examples:

- Upgrade effects
- Objective rewards
- District unlocks

Variable Rewards

Player gets uncertain results.

Examples:

- Supplier refresh
- Lucky crate
- Rare buyer
- Random demand event

Visual Rewards

Player sees something new.

Examples:

- Product icon
- District background
- Supplier portrait
- Rarity glow

34.2 Reward Cadence

Early game:

- Reward every 10–30 seconds

Mid game:

- Reward every 1–3 minutes

Late game:

- Reward every 5–15 minutes

This does not mean every reward must be huge. Small positive feedback matters.

35. Random Events

35.1 Event Purpose

Random events prevent the economy from feeling static.

35.2 Event Types

Demand Spike

A product category sells for more.

Supplier Discount

Supplier offers cheaper goods.

Heat Surge

Risk temporarily increases.

Rare Buyer

Special buyer offers premium price.

Glitch Deal

High-risk, high-reward offer.

35.3 MVP Event Examples

Event	Effect
Exam Week	Mood Mints sell +50% for 5 minutes
Retro Nostalgia Wave	Retro Relics sell +40%
Corporate Audit	Heat gain +25% for 3 minutes
Rainy Night	Comfort Goods sell +30%
Influencer Rumor	Vanity Mods sell +45%
Supplier Panic	One supplier discount -20%
Quiet Streets	Heat gain -30%
Glitch Window	Black-Box Tech profit +70%, heat +50%

36. Future Live Event Template

The first version should not require live events, but the structure should support them later.

36.1 Event Data Fields

Future event data should include:

- Event ID
- Display name
- Start time
- End time
- Featured products
- Featured supplier
- Reward modifiers
- Visual theme
- Objectives
- Reward table

36.2 Example Future Event

Neon Festival

Duration: 7 days

Effects:

- Candy-Tech demand +25%
- Festival-themed product icons
- Limited objectives
- Bonus rewarded ad crate

Possible rewards:

- Event badge
- Supplier skin
- District background variant
- Permanent 1% Candy-Tech bonus

36.3 Important Launch Rule

Do not build server-driven live events for MVP. Build local event data in a way that can later be moved server-side.

37. Analytics Plan

37.1 Why Analytics Matter

You need to know where players quit, whether ads are used, and whether the economy is too slow.

37.2 Events to Track

- Tutorial started
- Tutorial completed
- Product bought
- Product sold
- Upgrade bought
- District unlocked
- Heat warning triggered
- Lockdown triggered
- Rewarded ad offered
- Rewarded ad started
- Rewarded ad completed
- Session started
- Session ended
- Offline earnings claimed

37.3 Useful Metrics

- Tutorial completion rate
- First session length
- Day 1 retention
- Rewarded ad completion rate
- Average heat at quit
- Most purchased upgrades
- Bottleneck district

For early testing, even simple local debug analytics can help.

38. Balancing Tools

38.1 Developer Debug Menu

Build a simple hidden debug panel.

Functions:

- Add credits
- Add reputation
- Set heat
- Unlock all products

- Unlock all districts
- Reset save
- Simulate offline time
- Trigger random event
- Complete objective

38.2 Economy Spreadsheet

Before final balancing, create a spreadsheet with:

- Product costs
- Product profits
- Upgrade costs
- District unlock costs
- Expected income per minute
- Time to next unlock

38.3 Balance Targets

Early unlocks should feel fast.

If the player spends more than 3 minutes with no meaningful purchase in the first 15 minutes, the game is too slow.

39. Technical Implementation Order

39.1 Phase 1: Prototype

Goal: prove the buy/sell/upgrade loop is fun.

Build:

- Credits
- Inventory
- 3 products
- Buy/sell buttons
- 3 upgrades
- Save/load

No polish yet.

39.2 Phase 2: Core Systems

Build:

- Product ScriptableObject
- Supplier system
- Heat system

- District system
- Objectives
- Offline earnings

39.3 Phase 3: UI Polish

Build:

- Final dashboard
- Product cards
- Upgrade cards
- Popup system
- Count-up animations
- Unlock screens

39.4 Phase 4: Content Expansion

Add:

- 20 products
- 4 suppliers
- 4 districts
- 18 upgrades
- 40 objectives
- Random events

39.5 Phase 5: Ads and Analytics

Add:

- Rewarded ads
- Ad cooldowns
- Analytics events
- Offline double earnings

39.6 Phase 6: Testing and Balancing

Focus on:

- Tutorial clarity
 - Economy speed
 - Heat frustration
 - Ad usefulness
 - Save reliability
 - Crash bugs
-

40. Minimum Prototype Specification

40.1 Prototype Goal

Within one week of development, create a playable loop with ugly UI.

40.2 Prototype Content

Products:

- NovaCandy
- GlowGum
- Static Taffy

Upgrades:

- Better Packaging
- Hidden Locker
- Signal Scrambler

Systems:

- Credits
- Inventory
- Storage limit
- Heat
- Buy
- Sell
- Upgrade
- Save/load

40.3 Prototype Success Criteria

The prototype is successful if:

- Buying and selling feels immediately understandable
 - Money growth feels satisfying
 - Upgrades feel useful
 - Heat creates light tension
 - You can play for 5 minutes without getting bored as the developer
-

41. Example First 10 Minutes

Minute 0–1

Intro with Moth. Player buys and sells NovaCandy.

Minute 1-2

Player buys Better Packaging. Sale value increases.

Minute 2-3

Player buys more NovaCandy and sees heat rise.

Minute 3-4

Player unlocks GlowGum.

Minute 4-5

First heat warning appears. Player reduces heat or waits.

Minute 5-7

Player buys storage upgrade and can hold more products.

Minute 7-9

Player unlocks Static Taffy.

Minute 9-10

Player receives objective reward and sees Dorm Stack unlock goal.

42. UI Prefabs

42.1 Required Prefabs

`pf_screen_dashboard`

Main screen container.

`pf_screen_market`

Market screen container.

`pf_screen_inventory`

Inventory screen container.

`pf_screen_upgrades`

Upgrade screen container.

`pf_screen_districts`

District map screen container.

`pf_product_card`

Reusable product display card.

`pf_upgrade_card`

Reusable upgrade display card.

`pf_supplier_card`

Reusable supplier display card.

`pf_objective_card`

Reusable objective display card.

`pf_popup_reward`

Reward popup.

`pf_popup_warning_heat`

Heat warning popup.

`pf_popup_offline_earnings`

Offline earnings popup.

`pf_popup_unlock`

Unlock popup.

42.2 Prefab Naming

Use:

`pf_[category]_[name]`

Examples:

- `pf_ui_product_card`

- `pf_ui_upgrade_card`
 - `pf_popup_unlock`
 - `pf_popup_heat_warning`
-

43. UI Controller Classes

43.1 Screen Controllers

DashboardScreenController

Updates dashboard values and primary cards.

MarketScreenController

Displays suppliers and products.

InventoryScreenController

Displays owned products and sell actions.

UpgradeScreenController

Displays upgrades and purchase buttons.

DistrictScreenController

Displays locked/unlocked districts.

ObjectivePanelController

Displays active objective progress.

PopupController

Base class for popups.

NavigationController

Handles bottom navigation and screen transitions.

43.2 Card Controllers

ProductCardView

Displays product info and buy/sell buttons.

UpgradeCardView

Displays upgrade info and buy button.

SupplierCardView

Displays supplier info.

DistrictCardView

Displays district unlock info.

ObjectiveCardView

Displays objective progress and claim button.

44. Event System

44.1 Recommended Events

Use C# events or a simple event bus.

Events:

- CreditsChanged
- HeatChanged
- ReputationChanged
- InventoryChanged
- ProductUnlocked
- SupplierUnlocked
- DistrictUnlocked
- UpgradePurchased
- ObjectiveCompleted
- ObjectiveClaimed
- ShipmentCompleted
- OfflineEarningsCalculated

44.2 Why Events Help

Events allow UI to update without every UI script constantly polling managers.

Keep it simple. Do not build a giant complicated framework.

45. Ads Implementation Notes

45.1 Ad Reward Flow

1. Player taps rewarded ad button.
2. Game checks placement cooldown.
3. Game checks ad availability.
4. Ad plays.
5. On successful completion, reward is granted.
6. Cooldown starts.
7. Save game.

45.2 Reward Validation

Only grant reward after confirmed completion callback.

45.3 Failed Ad Handling

If ad fails:

- Do not grant reward
- Show friendly message
- Do not punish player

Example:

"Signal dropped. Try again later."

46. Accessibility and Usability

46.1 Basic Accessibility

- Large text option if possible
- Clear button states
- Avoid tiny tap targets
- Do not rely only on color for rarity
- Add icons and labels
- Reduce intense flashing

46.2 Mobile Usability

- Buttons minimum 44x44 points equivalent
 - Important actions near thumb-friendly zones
 - Short text
 - Clear confirmation for expensive purchases
 - No accidental ad taps
-

47. Localization

47.1 Prepare for Localization

Even if only English launches, avoid hardcoded UI strings.

Use string IDs.

Examples:

- `loc_product_novacandy_name`
- `loc_product_novacandy_desc`
- `loc_upgrade_better_packaging_name`
- `loc_tutorial_intro_001`

47.2 Text Style

Short, punchy, slightly sarcastic.

Avoid paragraphs in gameplay screens.

48. Example Dialogue Lines

48.1 Moth Tutorial Lines

- “Psst, kid. Wanna buy some candy?”
- “Relax. It’s only illegal because it tastes better than the approved stuff.”
- “Buy low, sell weird.”
- “Attention is expensive. Keep the meter sleepy.”
- “Same candy, shinier wrapper, higher price. Economics is fake magic.”
- “You’re in the market now. Stay cold. Sell weird.”

48.2 Heat Warning Lines

- “Corporate scanners are sniffing around.”
- “Your boxes look suspiciously profitable.”
- “Attention spike detected.”
- “Maybe stop glowing for five minutes.”

48.3 Unlock Lines

- “New supplier joined the whisper network.”
 - “New district unlocked.”
 - “The city gets bigger. So do the cravings.”
 - “Fresh demand detected.”
-

49. Product Descriptions

49.1 Examples

NovaCandy

A glowing candy cube banned for having “unregulated sparkle density.”

GlowGum

Chewing gum that lights up when you lie. Popular at parties, banned in meetings.

Static Taffy

Crackles softly in your pocket. Probably fine.

Pixel Pet Cartridge

A tiny digital pet that refuses software updates.

WarmLight Bulb

Makes any room feel like someone cares. Naturally, it is restricted.

Ghost SIM

A communication chip that exists only when nobody audits it.

50. Risk and Content Safety Direction

50.1 Fictionalization Rule

Keep all products fictional and absurd.

Do not include real illegal substances, weapons, or realistic criminal operations.

50.2 Violence Rule

No direct violence. Conflict is represented through:

- Scanners
- Audits
- Delays
- Corporate warnings
- Lockdowns
- Glitch interference

50.3 Humor Rule

Satirize systems, not suffering.

The player is not exploiting vulnerable people. They are moving silly banned products through a ridiculous city economy.

51. Production Asset Checklist

51.1 Art Assets

UI

- Main panel background
- Product cards by rarity
- Upgrade cards
- Buttons
- Icons
- Progress bars
- Heat meter
- Currency icon
- Storage icon
- Reputation icon
- Lock icon
- Warning icon
- Rewarded ad icon

Products

- 20 product icons
- 5 rarity frames
- Product glow overlays

Characters

- Moth neutral/success/warning
- Auntie Circuit neutral/success/warning
- Bluejay neutral/success/warning
- NullKid neutral/success/warning

Districts

- Back Alley background
- Dorm Stack background
- Neon Mall background
- Corporate Row background

VFX

- Unlock burst
- Currency fly effect
- Product sparkle
- Heat warning pulse
- Glitch transition

51.2 Audio Assets

- Button tap
- Buy product
- Sell product
- Currency gain
- Upgrade purchase
- Unlock
- Heat warning
- Shipment arrive
- Glitch transition
- Reward claim
- 2-4 music loops

51.3 Animation Assets

- Button press
 - Panel slide
 - Product reveal
 - Reward pulse
 - Heat shake
 - Unlock glow
 - Contact glitch in
 - District background loops
-

52. Development Risks

52.1 Biggest Risk: Economy Feels Boring

Fix:

- Increase reward frequency
- Add more objectives
- Add visual feedback
- Reduce early costs
- Unlock products faster

52.2 Biggest Risk: Scope Creep

Fix:

- Avoid route system until core loop works
- Avoid prestige until late game works
- Avoid too many products before balancing first 10
- Avoid complex narrative

52.3 Biggest Risk: UI Feels Cheap

Fix:

- Prioritize animations
- Use consistent spacing
- Use strong product icons
- Add sound feedback
- Add satisfying count-up effects

52.4 Biggest Risk: Heat Feels Annoying

Fix:

- Make penalties temporary
- Give clear warnings
- Add multiple reduction options
- Avoid losing permanent progress

53. Recommended First Development Milestone

53.1 Milestone Name

Playable Candy Loop

53.2 Goal

Create the smallest playable version that proves the core loop.

53.3 Requirements

- Player starts with \$ 50
- Player can buy NovaCandy
- Player can sell NovaCandy
- Credits update with animation
- Heat increases on buy/sell
- Player can buy Better Packaging
- Upgrade increases profit

- Save/load works
- App can close and reopen with progress preserved

53.4 Do Not Include Yet

- Multiple districts
- Ads
- Prestige
- Complex supplier system
- Polished art
- Dialogue beyond intro

This milestone should be ugly but playable.

54. Final Product Vision

The finished initial release should feel like a polished, compact idle tycoon game with a sharp identity.

The player starts with a glowing candy from a suspicious vendor and ends up managing an underground network of suppliers, buyers, districts, upgrades, and automated sales.

The game should be easy to open, satisfying to tap through, funny enough to remember, and structured enough to expand for months if it gains traction.

The most important design truth:

The player is not here for realism. The player is here to feel tiny progress turn into absurd momentum.